

Turnout Cascades in Adolescent Peer Networks

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Synthetic document written for the AI for Research knowledge-base demo. Not a real paper, and neither the author nor the journal exists.

Abstract

Using complete friendship rosters from 24 Veremian secondary schools, I show that first-time turnout clusters within peer networks beyond what shared neighbourhood and household characteristics predict.

1. Introduction

Turnout runs in families. This paper asks whether it also runs in friendships, and whether the clustering survives adjustment for the things friends have in common before they become friends.

2. Design

Rosters were collected in the final school year and linked to validated turnout at the first election each student was eligible to vote in. I compare observed clustering with clustering in networks rewired at random within school.

3. Results

Observed clustering exceeds the rewired benchmark in 21 of 24 schools. The excess is concentrated in reciprocated friendships.

4. Discussion

The pattern is consistent with peer influence and equally consistent with selection on unobserved political interest. The design cannot separate them, and the paper should not be cited as evidence that peer effects cause turnout.